Factsheet: John Pritchard Williamson (1922–2014)

Numbers in brackets refer to the Sources list in biography.md.

Name	John Pritchard Williamson (also John P. Williamson)
Born	Feb. 22, 1922, Cleveland, Ohio [2][6][7][8]
Died	Oct. 26, 2014, Parkcliffe Community, Northwood, near Toledo, Ohio; age 92 [1][2][9]
Parents	John and Jane (Pritchard) Williamson [2][6][10]
Spouse	Helen (Morgan) Williamson; married Aug. 3, 1945; she died Aug. 5, 2019 [5][10][36]
Children	Three sons [2][5]
Education	Kent State University, business administration degree, 1945 [5][12]; business manager of the Kent Stater (1944; again 1945) [30][13]; associate editor, Chestnut Burr [31][29]; Blue Key and Men's Union president [13]; Delta Sigma Pi, initiated 1942 [37][13]; University of Toledo managerial development certificate, 1956 [37]
Profession	Certified public accountant; Arthur Andersen & Company [2][11][6]; The Toledo Edison Company, 1951–1987 [5][11]
Toledo Edison career	1951 Director of Systems and Procedures [2][11][10]; 1962 secretary and treasurer [2][15]; c. 1965 vice president of finance [2][16][10]; 1968 senior vice president [2][10][7]; 1972 president and CEO (youngest since 1921) [1][19][20][21][17]; 1979 chairman and CEO [2][10][18]; 1987 chairman emeritus of Toledo Edison and Centerior Energy [1][5]
Notable projects	Davis-Besse Nuclear Power Station (at the helm through its 1977 startup) [1][22]; proposed the 1985 affiliation with Cleveland Electric Illuminating that created Centerior Energy [4][23][25]
Industry roles	Chairman, East Central Area Reliability Council [26][10]; president, Ohio Electric Utility Institute [10]; Edison Electric Institute executive committee; chairman, National Electric Security Committee [10]; chairman, North American Electric Reliability Council (3-year term from 1984) [10][27]; all per his obituary [2]
Civic leadership	Chairman, Greater Toledo Area United Way (1971); president, Toledo Community Chest (1972) [10][6]; past president, Toledo Kiwanis Club and Toledo Area Chamber of Commerce; past chairman, Ohio Chamber of Commerce [2]; first chairman, Toledo Development Committee [2][6]; Toledo Symphony trustee for nearly three decades, served as chairman [3]; boards include Toledo Museum of Art [28], Riverside Hospital, Toledo Hospital, Toledo Trust, First National Bank of Toledo [24], Red Cross, Junior Achievement, Boys Club [2]; Salvation Army board; a City of Toledo board; Ohio Development Advisory Council (commission dated March 5, 1976) [37]
Honors	Kent State Distinguished Alumnus Award, 1974 [12][5][2]; Toledo Area Citizen of the Year [2][14]; Kent State University medallion, 1992 [14]; Kentucky Colonel, Nov. 14, 1980; Toledo Area Chamber of Commerce citation, 1972 (president 1970); American National Red Cross citation, 1972 fund campaign; University of Toledo Centennial Fund citation, 1974; Medical College of Ohio citation, 1975; Kiwanis Legion of Honor, 1977 (25 years) [37]
Memberships	Delta Sigma Pi (life member 1975); Beta Alpha Psi (1969); Beta Gamma Sigma, University of Toledo chapter (1981); Delta Upsilon, Kent State chapter (1990) [37]
Kent State legacy	First life members of the Alumni Association (1975); lead gift for the Williamson Alumni Center (former Curtiss House, the president's home), dedicated Oct. 10, 1992 [33][35][5]; Kent State University Foundation board from 1992, emeritus 1997 [37]
Retirement	Homes in Rio Verde, Arizona, and Perrysburg, Ohio; horseback riding; world travel; Stephen Minister at Rio Verde Community Church (1996); Orvis fly-casting course (1983) and a French wines Certificat de Mérite [37]
Survivors named in obituary	Wife Helen (d. 2019); three sons; a grandson and a great-grandson; other family members [2]

Photos: main portrait, The Blade (Toledo Blade); couple photo, Photo by Bob Christy '95, Kent State University Alumni Association.

Sources used: [1] The Blade, news story, Oct. 28, 2014; [2] Legacy.com / The Blade family obituary, Oct. 28, 2014; [3] Toledo Community Foundation, Williamson's Donor Story; [4] The New York Times, June 27, 1985; [5] Kent State Magazine, Alumni Life tribute (Mar. 22, 2020); [6] Who's Who in Finance and Industry, 1975–76; [7] World Who's Who in Finance and Industry, 1969; [8] Find a Grave memorial 224691877; [9] Univ. of Toledo Alumni eMagazine, Jan. 29, 2015; [10] Who's Who in the Midwest, 1996–97; [11] Edison Electric Institute Bulletin, Nov. 1958; [12] Kent State, Past Alumni Award Recipients; [13] Chestnut Burr 1945; [14] Who's Who in America, 1992–93; [15] Who's Who in America, 1982–83; [16] Michigan State Univ., Institute of Public Utilities brochure (c. 1965–66); [17] Univ. of Toledo Canaday Center, John Davis Papers (MSS-338) finding aid; [18] Toledo Edison, Bay Shore Recognition Day (PRSA Silver Anvil entry, c. 1980); [19] U.S. NRC, Davis-Besse operating-license application amendment, Dec. 8, 1972 (ML19329B578); [20] U.S. NRC, Davis-Besse operating-license application, rev. Dec. 16, 1976 (ML20008D686); [21] Federal Register, Mar. 12, 1974, p. 9581 (FPC notice, Docket ID-1724); [22] World Nuclear Association, Davis Besse 1 reactor database entry; [23] U.S. NRC, Perry docket letter enclosing CEI press release, June 25, 1985 (ML20128R117); [24] Who's Who in the Midwest, 1988–89 and 2013; [25] UPI, Apr. 18, 1986; [26] NERC Annual Report 1981; [27] Prabook profile; [28] Toledo Museum of Art, Annual Report 1989–90; [29] Chestnut Burr 1944; [30] Kent Stater, Jan. 26, 1945; [31] Kent Stater, Dec. 12, 1944; [32] Kent State, Alumni Award Categories; [33] Kent State Alumni Association, Williamson Alumni Center History; [34] Kent State Alumni, Mission and History timeline; [35] Kent State Libraries, Cartwright papers finding aid; [36] Helen Williamson obituary, The Blade/Legacy.com, Aug. 2019; [37] Williamson family collection, Honors, Certificates & Distinctions booklet (family-held)